



How can the range of your strategic foresight be lengthened by using a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram?

When planning, the further you can project your strategic thinking into the future, the better. This is known as having 'strategic foresight'. It is easy enough for people who are planning to think one or two steps ahead. However, when attempting to conceive of each additional step into the future, people's ability to imagine what is likely to happen reduces.

One of the advantages of using DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams is that they make it easier to project yourself forward. Such diagrams encourage this because they are organized around a visual causal flow from left to right.

A traditional strategic plan that only sets out a 'flat' (that is, non-casually-sequenced) set of strategies and outcomes does not visually present the future dimension as clearly as a DoView diagram showing left to right 'This-Then' flow. This means that, when using traditional text-based planning documents, the minds of planners, decision-makers, and stakeholders are less able to project into the future than when using a DoView diagram.

Of course, planning documents sometimes include timelines. These can help people think about the future. But these can be contrasted with the DoView diagrams used in DoView Planning with their left-to-right causal flow. Normal timelines tend to be lower-level and focused in a more detailed way on the time dimension. In contrast, DoViews can be viewed as overall 'fuzzy sequence-flows' rather than tight timelines. The boxes in them follow each other in a 'This-Then' sequence, but different parts of the DoView diagram can move at different 'time speeds' from each other. DoView diagrams also tend to be struck at a higher-level than most timelines used within traditional planning.

This DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagrams Helping to Extend Strategic Foresight Explainer (B13), shows how DoView diagrams help us think more about what will happen in the future. Being able to do this lies at the heart of best practice strategic thinking and planning.